



Faculty of Business and Management Co-Operative Education Coursework Submission Form

Student Name : Chia Jem Kui
Subject Code : BBA3014

Student ID : 1002371572
Programme : BCBFT

Subject Name : Cooperative Placement 3

Semester : Jan / May / **Sept** 2026

Supervisor : Dr. Braham Rahul Ram

Assignment Number/Title : Co-operative Placement 3 Assignment

Due Date : 27 Sept 2026

Assignment Weightage : 50%

All work must be submitted by the due date.

If an extension is granted, this must be specified with the extended due date and a signature from the lecturer or tutor.

Extension until:

Signature of Lecturer/Tutor.....

Student's Statement:

I hereby declare that the work submitted is my own. I confirmed that I have read and understood the University regulations with regard to plagiarism, and that Plagiarism, Collusion and Cheating in this work will be penalized.

Note:

- 1) You are expected to retain copies of your assignment report.
- 2) If you require an acknowledgement receipt of this assignment, please prepare a duplicate copy of this form.

Student Signature

Date: 25 Sep 2026

Receipt of Assessment

Assessment Received by
(Name & Signature)

Date/Time

Student's Checklist: I have met the following Assessment Criteria (Check ☒ relevant boxes)

A) Assignment	
(1) Submission form	☐
(2) Cover page	☐
(3) Format	☐
(4) Assignment content	☐
B) Employer Evaluation	☐

Weightage	Mark	%
50%		
50%		

(To be filled by the faculty)

Co-op Supervisor's Comments:

Co-op Supervisor's Signature _____ Date _____

TOTAL:

Report Grade: _____

MARK KEY:

- 0 = Totally inadequate
- 1 = Very poor effort
- 2 = Minimum satisfactory effort
- 3 = Fairly good to good
- 4 = Very good
- 5 = Excellent



Faculty of Business and Management

Co-Operative Education



A coursework completed as part of the requirement for

PROGRAMME	: Financial Technology
SUBJECT NAME	: Co-Operative Placement 3
SUBJECT CODE	: BBA3014
COOP SUPERVISOR	: Dr. Braham Rahul Ram

COOPERATIVE PLACEMENT ASSIGNMENT

Submitted on

DATE OF SUBMISSION	:
DUE DATE	: 27 Sept 2026

Produced by

STUDENT NAME	: Chia Jem Kui
STUDENT ID	: 1002371572

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

1. For those who having **TWO** Co-Op in one semester, you should submit 2 assignments and also 2 Employer Evaluation Forms.
2. Both assignments and employer evaluation should be stated clearly the term of particular Co-Op (i.e. Co-Op 1, Co-Op 2 or Co-Op 3)
3. Assignment should be submitted in CN dropbox with the cover page. **You are not allowed to submit by email.**
4. Assignment should be submitted together with the completed submission form in following order:
 - i. Submission Form
 - ii. Cover Page
 - iii. Assignment
 - iv. Appendix if applicable (marks will be deducted if irrelevant materials attached)
5. The submission **due dates for assignments**: Please refer CN announcement.
6. The Employer Evaluation form should be submitted by **week 8** of your internship period. Please remind your company to submit the form on time.
7. **LATE SUBMISSION OF ASSIGNMENT IS NOT ACCEPTABLE and MARKS WILL BE DEDUCTED AS SHOWN BELOW**
8. For inquiry regarding Co-Op, do not hesitate to contact:
Dr Marcia Edna Santhana Rajan for B.Sc. (Hons) in Accounting & B.Sc. (Hons) in **Dr Braham Rahul Ram** via email Braham@ucsuniuniversity.edu.my to me only or wat app 011-55062289. An extension shall be granted from case to case basis but the general guidelines as below follows:-

Late within a day	Deduct 10 marks
Late within two days	Deduct 20 marks
Late within seven days	Deduct 30 marks
Late thereafter	Zero mark will be awarded

9. The consequences of not following these guidelines will be solely on student responsibility.
 10. Any latest information will be updated through [My Employment & Co-Op Portal](#)
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Format of assignment:-

- **Font Size:- 12**
- **Font Type:- Times New Roman**
- **Line Spacing:- 1.5 lines**
- **Alignment Justified**
- **2cm Top and Bottom Margins 2.5cm Right and Left Margins**

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer all questions. Your response must be based on your work experience in the organization where you undergone internship. Your answer should not exceed **2,500 words**.

Questions:

Q1. Describe the organization in terms of:

- i. Background or history of the host company (5 marks)
- ii. Types of Products/ services offered (5 marks)
- iii. Overview of the industry that host company is involved in (10 marks)

Q2. You are required to explain comprehensively and give comments in your own words on the accounting and/or finance courses applicable in relation to the host company's practice/s. (ie: Preparation of Financial Statement, Investment/ Ratio analysis and etc) (15 marks)

Q3. To the best of your knowledge, describe the compliance of the host company to the accounting standard/company act/any standards related. (15 marks)

(TOTAL 50 MARKS)

Introduction

I completed my cooperative placement as a Finance Intern in the Financial Reporting department of Hibiscus Oil & Gas Malaysia Limited, an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad. The placement allowed me to observe how accounting principles, financial controls and data-processing tools are applied in an upstream oil and gas group. My exposure included monthly bank reconciliations, financial working files for internal review, Annual Financial Statements workings, schedules for external auditors, ESG information for the Group, and a bank-reconciliation automation that uses optical character recognition on bank-statement PDFs. This report describes the organisation, explains how my accounting and finance courses were applied during the placement, and discusses the company's compliance with relevant standards and legislation. The discussion of my work is presented at a general level and does not disclose confidential company information.

Q1. Description of the Organisation

i. Background or History of the Host Company

The host company was Hibiscus Oil & Gas Malaysia Limited, an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad and the operator of the Kinabalu Oil PSC.

Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad is a Malaysian public listed company headquartered in Kuala Lumpur. It was incorporated in 2007 and is recognised as Malaysia's first listed independent oil and gas exploration and production company. The company was listed on the Main Market of Bursa Malaysia Securities Berhad on 25 July 2011 under the Special Purpose Acquisition Company, or SPAC, listing framework. It was also the first SPAC listed in Southeast Asia. After completing its qualifying acquisition in 2012, the company was reclassified from a SPAC to an oil and gas company (Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad, 2025a; 2025b).

The Group subsequently expanded from an exploration-focused company into an operator and producer. A major milestone was the acquisition of a 50% interest in the Anasuria Cluster and related floating production, storage and offloading facility in the United Kingdom North Sea in 2016. In 2018, SEA Hibiscus Sdn Bhd assumed operatorship of the North Sabah Enhanced Oil Recovery Production Sharing Contract after acquiring Shell's participating interest. The Group further expanded its Malaysian and Vietnamese

portfolio in 2022 and completed the acquisition of an interest in Block B Maharajalela Jamalulalam in Brunei Darussalam in 2024. As at the 2024/2025 reporting period, the Group had production, development and exploration interests across Malaysia, Vietnam, Brunei Darussalam, the United Kingdom and Australia.

The company's development reflects a strategy of acquiring suitable oil and gas assets, improving production from existing fields and selectively pursuing new opportunities. Its stated vision is to be a respected, valuable and responsible energy company. Accordingly, its objectives are not limited to financial returns, but also include operational safety, environmental responsibility, corporate governance and long-term value creation.

ii. Types of Products and Services Offered

Hibiscus Petroleum operates in the upstream segment of the oil and gas industry. Its main products are crude oil, natural gas, condensate and other hydrocarbons produced from the fields in which the Group holds participating interests. Revenue is mainly earned when the Group's share of hydrocarbons is delivered and control is transferred to customers. The amount earned is affected by production volume, the quality of the hydrocarbon, contractual terms and market-linked oil and gas prices.

The Group also undertakes activities and services across the upstream project life cycle. These include exploration and appraisal, geological and geophysical studies, drilling, field-development planning, offshore production operations, well maintenance, production enhancement, asset-integrity management and decommissioning planning. The FY2025 financial statements also identify project-management, technical, processing and other services related to oil and gas exploration and production as part of the Group's activities (Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad, 2025a). Where Hibiscus Petroleum is the operator, it coordinates daily production, contractors, maintenance, health and safety requirements and operational reporting. Where it is a non-operating partner, it participates according to the rights and obligations of the relevant joint arrangement or production-sharing contract.

iii. Overview of the Industry

The upstream oil and gas industry covers the exploration, development and production of petroleum resources. It is different from the midstream segment, which

focuses on transportation and storage, and the downstream segment, which covers refining, distribution and retail. Upstream activities require substantial expenditure on licences, seismic studies, drilling, offshore platforms, subsea equipment and production facilities. The industry is therefore capital-intensive and requires long-term planning.

The industry also contains significant uncertainty. A company cannot know with complete accuracy how much oil or gas can be recovered, how quickly a field will produce or how future commodity prices will move. Revenue and profitability may change because of fluctuations in crude oil and gas prices, production disruptions, contractor costs, foreign-exchange rates and changes in reserve estimates. Oil and gas fields are depleting assets, so production will normally decline unless the operator carries out activities such as infill drilling, workovers, enhanced recovery, new-field development or asset acquisitions.

In Malaysia, upstream activities are commonly conducted through Production Sharing Contracts administered by PETRONAS through Malaysia Petroleum Management. These contracts determine matters such as participating interests, work commitments, cost recovery, production sharing, reporting and decommissioning obligations. Operations in other countries are governed by the respective licences, concessions, tax regimes and regulatory authorities.

Health, safety and environmental management are particularly important because offshore operations involve risks such as equipment failure, fire, spills, severe weather and workplace injury. Companies must also estimate and provide for the future cost of dismantling facilities and restoring sites. In addition, the energy transition has increased expectations concerning greenhouse-gas emissions, climate risk, environmental impact and sustainability disclosure. Therefore, the industry requires cooperation among finance, operations, engineering, legal, tax, risk and sustainability functions.

Q2. Application of Accounting and Finance Courses to the Company's Practices

Financial Accounting and Financial Reporting

My financial-accounting courses helped me understand the company's general-ledger and reporting processes. Transactions from different business units must be recorded using the correct account code and reporting period before they can be summarised in financial statements. During my placement, I prepared financial working files for internal review,

supported Annual Financial Statements workings, and reviewed ledger extracts, transaction descriptions and supporting schedules. This showed me that the substance of a transaction is more important than its wording. For example, a payment may represent an operating expense, capital expenditure, prepayment, intercompany balance or another category depending on its purpose and period of benefit.

The concepts of double entry, accrual accounting and cut-off were directly applicable. An expense must be recognised in the correct period even when the invoice or payment occurs at a different time. Items benefiting future periods may require prepayment treatment, while costs already incurred but not yet invoiced may require accruals. Incorrect timing or account classification could affect expenses, assets, liabilities, profit and management reporting. My coursework therefore helped me understand why supporting documents, clear descriptions and review procedures are required before balances are finalised. For company-specific accounting treatments, I still needed guidance, and this improved through financial statement preparation and audit support.

Bank Reconciliation and OCR Automation

One of the most meaningful applications of my studies was bank reconciliation. A bank reconciliation compares the company's accounting records with bank information and explains differences such as timing items, unpresented payments, deposits in transit, bank charges, duplicated entries or transactions not yet recorded in the ledger. This task applies financial accounting because the final reconciled balance must agree with the amount reported as cash and bank balances.

Monthly bank reconciliation was a core task. Statements arrived as PDFs in different layouts from different banks, so the work was heavily manual. I further developed the automation so that optical character recognition extracts dates, amounts, descriptions and references from those PDFs, compares them with the accounting records, separates matched items from exceptions, and produces an Excel output for review. This made unmatched transactions, possible duplicates and items requiring investigation easier to see.

A practical issue I encountered was that the bank-reference field shown in a bank statement could differ from the reference extracted from another bank format. Therefore, matching could not depend on one field alone. The automation had to consider a

combination of amount, date, transaction description and available reference information, while unusual items remained subject to manual review. This experience taught me that automation improves speed and consistency but does not remove the need for accounting judgement. It also showed the importance of data validation, exception reporting and maintaining an audit trail so that a reviewer can understand how each item was matched.

This work was closely related to Accounting Information Systems and financial data analytics. I learned how accounting controls can be incorporated into a technical workflow. For example, the program should not silently force a match when several transactions have the same amount. Instead, uncertain cases should be flagged for review. The automation therefore supported, rather than replaced, the preparer and reviewer controls in the reconciliation process.

Management Accounting and Expenditure Classification

Management-accounting concepts were applicable when I assisted with operating-expenditure working papers and ESG reporting information for submission to the Group. I reviewed transaction-level data and applied the required methodology to distinguish PMT and non-PMT items and to classify relevant transactions into categories such as recurring, non-recurring, intercompany and Z* items. The work required a consistent sequence of review because one classification rule could take priority over another.

This task demonstrated the importance of cost classification. A transaction cannot be classified accurately only by looking at the account name; the description, counterparty, business purpose, supporting documentation and relationship with other group entities may also need to be considered. Consistent classification makes management reports and sustainability expenditure reports more comparable between entities and reporting periods. I also learned that unexplained or missing classifications should be investigated instead of being assigned based on assumption.

Internal Controls, Reconciliations and Audit Trail

My auditing and accounting courses helped me understand the control purpose of reconciliations and review procedures. During the placement, detailed workings were expected to agree with the relevant ledger balance or report total. Differences had to be traced to their source and supported with explanations. I also compiled supporting documents and schedules for the external auditors. Preparers and reviewers needed clear

working papers, consistent file versions and evidence supporting significant adjustments.

The experience showed me how segregation of duties, approval controls, restricted system access and independent review reduce the risk of error or unauthorised transactions. Excel and the reconciliation automation were useful tools, but control quality still depended on complete source data, correct formulas, version control and review of exceptions. This changed my understanding of auditing: an audit trail is created through daily documentation and review, not only when external auditors arrive.

Fixed Assets, Financial Analysis and Professional Judgement

The accounting treatment of property, plant and equipment was also relevant. The company must distinguish capital expenditure from operating expenditure, maintain asset information and calculate depreciation or depletion using an appropriate basis. For oil and gas properties, accounting is more complex than ordinary straight-line depreciation because production and reserve estimates may affect depletion and impairment assessments. My exposure to net-book-value and fixed-asset information helped me understand why the cost, accumulated depreciation, additions, disposals and closing balance must reconcile.

Finance and ratio-analysis courses helped me interpret the wider effect of accounting information. Profitability and liquidity ratios are useful, but an upstream company should also be assessed using operating measures such as production volume, realised commodity prices, unit operating costs, reserves, capital expenditure and decommissioning commitments. Overall, my placement showed that accounting knowledge, finance analysis and technology are interconnected. Accurate financial information depends on both technical processing and professional judgement.

Q3. Compliance with Accounting Standards, the Companies Act and Other Requirements

To the best of my knowledge, Hibiscus Petroleum has established financial-reporting and control processes to address the requirements applicable to a Malaysian public listed upstream oil and gas group. My comments are based on my internship exposure and publicly available information and do not represent an independent legal or audit opinion.

Financial Reporting Standards

The Group's FY2025 financial statements state that they were prepared in accordance with Malaysian Financial Reporting Standards, International Financial Reporting Standards and the Companies Act 2016. The independent auditors reported that the financial statements gave a true and fair view of the Group's and Company's financial position as at 30 June 2025 and of their financial performance and cash flows for the year (Hibiscus Petroleum Berhad, 2025a). The Malaysian Accounting Standards Board confirms that MFRSs are the official accounting pronouncements applicable in Malaysia (MASB, 2026).

Several standards are particularly relevant to the company. MFRS 6 applies to exploration and evaluation expenditure. The Group's accounting policy states that qualifying exploration costs are accumulated by area of interest, while costs relating to an abandoned area are written off. MFRS 116 and MFRS 136 are relevant to property, plant and equipment, depletion and impairment. MFRS 15 is relevant to oil and gas sales, for which revenue is generally recognised when control of the hydrocarbons is transferred to the customer. MFRS 137 is important for decommissioning provisions because the future cost of dismantling facilities and restoring sites is estimated, discounted and reviewed. Other relevant standards include MFRS 9 for financial instruments, MFRS 16 for leases, MFRS 112 for taxation, MFRS 121 for foreign currency, and MFRS 10 and MFRS 11 for group and joint-arrangement reporting.

Companies Act, Bursa Malaysia and Corporate Governance

The Companies Act 2016 requires proper accounting records and financial statements that give a true and fair view. As a Main Market listed issuer, Hibiscus Petroleum is also subject to Bursa Malaysia's Main Market Listing Requirements, including periodic financial reporting, disclosure of material information, annual-report requirements, related-party transaction rules and corporate-governance disclosure (Bursa Malaysia, 2026a). The annual report describes governance arrangements involving the Board, Board committees, management, internal control, internal audit and external audit.

The controls I observed in the Financial Reporting department were consistent with these objectives. Transactions and balances were supported by detailed working papers, reconciliations and review. The bank-reconciliation automation also reflected compliance principles because it was designed to identify exceptions rather than conceal them. A

controlled automation should preserve source information, show the matching result and allow a reviewer to investigate unusual transactions.

Sustainability, Petroleum and Other Regulatory Requirements

Bursa Malaysia requires listed issuers to include sustainability information in their annual reports and has enhanced the sustainability-reporting framework in alignment with IFRS Sustainability Disclosure Standards. These requirements increase the importance of reliable environmental, social and governance data and the connection between sustainability information and financial reporting (Bursa Malaysia, 2024; 2026b). My involvement in ESG information for the Group showed that reported sustainability amounts must be traceable to transaction-level accounting records and classified using consistent criteria.

The Group must also comply with its Production Sharing Contracts, licences and concessions in each operating jurisdiction. These may contain requirements relating to work programmes, cost recovery, production sharing, taxation, reporting and decommissioning. Health, safety and environmental laws are also significant because non-compliance could result in operational disruption, penalties, remediation costs or reputational damage. In conclusion, compliance is not limited to preparing the annual report. It begins with accurate transaction recording, proper authorisation, consistent classification, timely reconciliation, supporting documentation and effective review throughout the year.